Emeka Okonkwo-Bell

Lead Full-Stack Developer

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SUMMARY

Lead developer with fourteen years in product companies, mostly Ruby on Rails with React frontends. I enjoy turning vague requirements into shippable increments and keeping codebases healthy through steady refactoring. Away from the keyboard, I run a monthly engineering book club and support a local programme introducing teenagers to web development. I value pragmatism over fashion.

SKILLS

Ruby on Rails, Ruby, React, Redux, PostgreSQL, Sidekiq, RSpec, Elasticsearch, Stripe API, Heroku, Agile coaching, Capybara, Redis

EXPERIENCE

Lead Developer, Pennine Bookings Ltd — 2018 – Present

- Lead a team of seven building a two-sided marketplace; gross bookings grew from £4m to £19m during my tenure.
- Planned the move from server-rendered views to a React frontend over eighteen months without a feature freeze.
- Brought page load time on search from 3.5 s to 0.9 s using Elasticsearch and caching.
- Own hiring and onboarding for the team.
- Present quarterly metrics to the leadership team and translate business goals into technical roadmaps.

Senior Rails Developer, Mersey Media Apps — 2013 – 2018

- Built subscription billing with Stripe and a self-service account area.
- Introduced RSpec test conventions and pairing sessions.
- Handled production support during a busy launch quarter.
- Reduced Sidekiq queue latency from minutes to seconds by splitting queues and tuning concurrency.
- Mentored four developers into senior roles.

Web Developer, Calder Creative — 2010 – 2013

- Delivered PHP and early Rails sites for agency clients.
- Learned the fundamentals of version control, testing and client communication in a busy agency.
- Delivered more than thirty small sites.
- Introduced weekly refactoring slots that reduced the average age of the most-changed files and the number of regressions.
- Negotiated scope with stakeholders and kept a visible, honest delivery forecast.

EDUCATION

- BSc Software Engineering, University of Northern Counties (2006 – 2010)

LANGUAGES

English (native), Igbo (conversational)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Scrum Master, Northern Agile Institute

- Leading Engineering Teams, Manchester Business Academy